

Acceptance Study of Veganism in First year students of IHM Mumbai.

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Introduction:

Definitions of veganism:

Veganism is the practice of abstaining from the use of animal products, particularly in diet, and an associated philosophy that rejects the commodity status of animals. An individual who follows the diet or philosophy is known as a **vegan**.

"Veganism is a philosophy and way of living which seeks to exclude—as far as is possible and practicable—all forms of exploitation of, and cruelty to, animals for food, clothing or any other purpose; and by extension, promotes the development and use of animal-free alternatives for the benefit of animals, humans and the environment. In dietary terms it denotes the practice of dispensing with all products derived wholly or partly from animals."

The word **vegan** was coined by Donald Watson and his then-future wife Dorothy Morgan in 1944.

World Vegan Day is held every 1st November to mark the society's creation. Donald Watson, secretary of the Leicester Vegetarian Society, set up a new quarterly newsletter "Vegan News" in November 1944. He chose the word vegan himself. The first edition attracted over 100 letters from people who resolved to give up eggs and dairy. Vegan News changed its name to The Vegan in November 1945 and by now it had 500 subscribers. It published recipes, health news and a "vegan trade list" of animal-free products such as Colgate toothpaste, Kiwi shoe polish, Dawson & Owen stationery (Gupta, 2016).

(Sengupta, S. (2017). World Vegan Day: Is It Difficult To Be Vegan In India? Retrieved November 3rd, 2019, from NDTV Food: <https://food.ndtv.com/food-drinks/world-vegan-days-is-it-difficult-to-be-vegan-in-india-1769823>)

Vegetarianism encompasses a spectrum of eating patterns: from diets that leave out all animal meats and products (vegan) to diets that include eggs, milk, and milk products. Plant-based diets refer to diets predominantly based on plant foods, including most vegetarian diets and other diets in the spectrum, such as those including fish (Tonstad et al., 2009). In general, vegetarian diets provide relatively large amounts of cereals, pulses, nuts, fruits, and vegetables. In terms of nutrients, vegetarian diets are usually rich in carbohydrates, n-6 fatty acids, dietary fibre, carotenoids, folic acid, vitamin C, vitamin E, and Mg and relatively low in protein, saturated fat, long-chain n-3 fatty acids, retinol, vitamin B(12), and Zn (Key et al., 2006). In recent years, the vegetarian dietary pattern has been adopted by an increasing number of people in Western countries (Fraser, 2009), where it is usually an adopted lifestyle by choice during adulthood (Fraser, 2009). Moreover, vegetarianism is not common in the West (<5% of the population) (Key et al., 2006), which limits the power of studies examining the macro- and micronutrient value of vegetarian diets (Fraser, 2009; Key et al., 2006; Obers by et al., 2013; Baines et al., 2007). By contrast, a substantial proportion of the Indian population (35%) are vegetarians (Key et al., 2006) (10%–62% for different regions) (Arnold et al., 2009). The history of vegetarianism has its roots in the civilization of ancient India, and the origin of vegetarian-ism in India has often been linked to the cow protectionism and veneration associated with Hindu culture (Narayan, 2008). The earliest records of vegetarianism as a concept and practice among a significant number of people concerns ancient India (Spencer, 1993), where the diet was closely connected with the idea of non-violence toward animals (called ahimsa in India) and was promoted by religious groups and philosophers (Walters and Portmess, 2001).

History of veganism:

Vegetarianism can be traced to Indus Valley civilization in 3300–1300 BCE in the Indian subcontinent, particularly in northern and western ancient India. Early vegetarians included Indian philosophers such as Parshavnatha, Mahavira, Acharya Kundakunda, Umaswati, Samantabhadra, and the Tamil poet Valluvar; the Indian emperors Chandragupta Maurya and Ashoka; Greek philosophers such as Empedocles, Theophrastus, Plutarch, Plotinus, and Porphyry; and the Roman poet Ovid and

the playwright Seneca the Younger. The Greek sage Pythagoras may have advocated an early form of strict vegetarianism, but his life is so obscure that it is disputed whether he ever advocated any form of vegetarianism at all. He almost certainly prohibited his followers from eating beans and from wearing woollen garments. Eudoxus of Cnidus, a student of Archytas and Plato, writes that "Pythagoras was distinguished by such purity and so avoided killing and killers that he not only abstained from animal foods, but even kept his distance from cooks and hunters". One of the earliest known vegans was the Arab poet al-Ma'arri (c. 973 – c. 1057). Their arguments were based on health, the transmigration of souls, animal welfare, and the view—espoused by Porphyry in *De Abstinencia ab Esu Animalium* ("On Abstinence from Animal Food", c. 268 – c. 270)—that if humans deserve justice, then so do animals.

Vegetarianism established itself as a significant movement in 19th-century Britain and the United States. A minority of vegetarians avoided animal food entirely. In 1813, the poet Percy Bysshe Shelley published *A Vindication of Natural Diet*, advocating "abstinence from animal food and spirituous liquors", and in 1815, William Lambe, a London physician, stated that his "water and vegetable diet" could cure anything from tuberculosis to acne. Lambe called animal food a "habitual irritation", and argued that "milk eating and flesh-eating are but branches of a common system and they must stand or fall together". Sylvester Graham's meatless Graham diet—mostly fruit, vegetables, water, and bread made at home with stoneground flour—became popular as a health remedy in the 1830s in the United States. Several vegan communities were established around this time. In Massachusetts, Amos Bronson Alcott, father of the novelist Louisa May Alcott, opened the Temple School in 1834 and Fruitlands in 1844, and in England, James Pierrepont Greaves founded the Concordium, a vegan community at Alcott House on Ham Common, in 1838.

Although the vegan diet was defined early on in The Vegan Society's beginnings in 1944, it was as late as 1949 before Leslie J Cross pointed out that the society lacked a definition of veganism. He suggested "the principle of the emancipation of animals from exploitation by man". This is later clarified as "to seek an end to the use of animals by man for food, commodities, work, hunting, vivisection, and by all other uses involving exploitation of animal life by man".

The society was first registered as a charity in August 1964 but its assets were later transferred to a new charity when it also became a limited company in December 1979. The definition of

veganism and the charitable objects of the society were amended and refined over the years. By winter 1988 the current definition was in use - although the phrasing has changed slightly over the years.

Categories of veganism:

Distinctions may be made between several categories of veganism. **Dietary vegans**, also known as "strict vegetarians", refrain from consuming meat, eggs, dairy products, and any other animal-derived substances.

An **ethical vegan** is someone who not only follows a plant-based diet but extends the philosophy into other areas of their lives, opposes the use of animals for any purpose, and tries to avoid any cruelty and exploitation of all animals including humans.

Another term is "**environmental veganism**", which refers to the avoidance of animal products on the premise that the industrial farming of animals is environmentally damaging and unsustainable.

Types of vegan lifestyle:

According to Alina Petre, Healthline (2019) prominent types of this lifestyle include:

1. **Dietary vegans:** Often used interchangeably with “plant-based eaters,” this term refers to those who avoid animal products in their diet but continue to use them in other products, such as clothing and cosmetics.
2. **Whole-food vegans:** These individuals favor a diet rich in whole foods, such as fruits, vegetables, whole grains, legumes, nuts, and seeds.
3. **Junk-food vegans:** Some people rely heavily on processed vegan food, such as vegan meats, fries, frozen dinners, and desserts, including Oreo cookies and non-dairy ice cream.

4. **Raw-food vegans:** This group eats only foods that are raw or cooked at temperatures below 118°F (48°C).
5. **Low-fat, raw-food vegans:** Also known as fruitarians, this subset limits high-fat foods, such as nuts, avocados, and coconuts, instead relying mainly on fruit. Other plants are occasionally eaten in small amounts.

Bangalore based nutritionist Dr. Anju says, “Indian population is largely non-meat based. For them the source of protein is mainly derived out of plant origin foods like dal, rajma and the likes. If paneer, milk and curd are ruled out, then to ensure there is enough protein and calcium in their diet, proper planning must be done in consultation with an expert.” (Sengupta, NDTV Foods, 2017).

Difference between vegetarianism and veganism:

Vegans and vegetarians choose not to eat meat. However, veganism is stricter and also prohibits dairy, eggs, honey, and any other items that derive from animal products, such as leather and silk.

Both veganism and vegetarianism are growing in popularity. However, some people may find the differences between these two diets a little confusing, particularly as there are several variations of vegetarianism.

Vegetarianism:

According to the Vegetarian Society, vegetarians are people who do not eat the products or byproducts of animal slaughter.

Vegetarians do not consume:

- meat, such as beef, pork, and game
- poultry, such as chicken, turkey, and duck
- fish and shellfish

- insects
- rennet, gelatine, and other types of animal protein
- stock or fats that derive from animal slaughter

However, many vegetarians do consume by-products that do not involve the slaughter of animals. These include:

- eggs
- dairy products, such as milk, cheese, and yogurt
- honey

Vegetarians typically consume a range of fruits, vegetables, nuts, seeds, grains, and pulses, as well as “meat substitutes” that derive from these food types.

Vegetarianism is generally less strict than veganism, so there are several well-known variations of the vegetarian diet. These include:

- **Lacto-ovo-vegetarian.** People who follow this diet avoid all types of meat and fish but do consume dairy products and eggs.
- **Lacto-vegetarian.** People on this diet do not eat any meat, fish, or eggs but do consume dairy products.
- **Ovo-vegetarian.** Individuals following this diet do not eat any meat, fish, or dairy products but do consume eggs.
- **Pescatarian.** Those who follow this diet avoid all meats except fish and other types of seafood. However, this does not meet the traditional definition of vegetarianism, and many people refer to the pescatarian diet as being semi-vegetarian or flexitarian.

Veganism:

Veganism is a stricter form of vegetarianism. Vegans avoid consuming or using any animal products or by-products. The Vegan Society define veganism as “a way of living, which seeks to exclude, as far as is possible and practicable, all forms of exploitation of and cruelty to animals for food, clothing, or any other purpose.”

Vegans strictly avoid consuming any foods or beverages that contain:

- meat
- poultry
- fish and shellfish
- eggs
- dairy products
- honey
- insects
- rennet, gelatine and other types of animal protein
- stock or fats that derive from animals

Strict vegans also extend these principles beyond their diet and will try, where possible, to avoid any product that directly or indirectly involves the human use of animals. These products can include:

- leather goods
- wool
- silk
- beeswax
- soaps, candles, and other products that contain animal fats, such as tallow
- latex products that contain casein, which comes from milk proteins
- cosmetics or other products that manufacturers test on animals

Many vegetarians also apply some of these principles to their lifestyle, for example, by avoiding leather goods and products that involve animal testing.

CHAPTER 1:

Review of Literature

Popular vegan restaurants in Mumbai:

1. Aharveda:

Aharveda Lifestyle:

“Ahar”: means food in Sanskrit

“Veda”: defined as scripture containing philosophies.

“A balanced way of life,” Aharveda combines principles of wellness-centric food science practiced in ancient India and decades of experience in producing nutritious & tasty food.

Address: Viral Apartments, Behind Hotel Radhakrishna, Next to Hotel Golden Chariot, SV Rd, Opp. Shoppers Stop, Andheri West, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400058

Testimonials:

- “Their menu is creative enough to generate interest. Food is equally impressive. They have lot of great options. we tried thali, protein salad and several juices. Food was truly balanced, authentic taste, no unnecessary spices. By any means it did not taste like it is made commercially.

As they have lot of good options to try, I am going to visit it again.” By Eamil Makwana.

- “Food served on silver platters. Great service.

I found the menu not Ayurveda style, which is what I was expecting.

The thali is nice and coconut milk chaas is included. I had sugarcane juice and Sri lankan stewed idli, those were really nice

They give you a warm finger bowl to wash your hands after eating the thali. I really like that traditional ritual of finger bowl with lemon.

Clean restrooms/ toilets and nice place” by Angel Trata.

2. Rare Earth the vegan café:

Address: C/O RARE EARTH ORGANICS Sethi nivas, Opp. Bharat co-op bank, behind parmar tailors, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400052

Testimonials:

- “Food was good. We had pasta and a burger. We also had vegan gulab jamun which we didn't take photo but it was amazing. I would say the best I have ever had. And considering I am not a fan of gulab jamun, that's something. It also has a store so you can buy yourself some vegan products.” By Suresh Patel.
- “My first time in a vegan cafe everything was beautiful. The ambience is very earthy with both indoor and outdoor sitting. They also have vegan stuff that they sell. It is 3 mins walking distance from khar station. We tried a lot of stuff 1. Pink pasta - tasty and filling with good portion sizes 2. Watermelon feta salad - one thing that you will never try anywhere. A different taste if you are curious and ok to explore too much. 3. Sizzler 7 burger - best vegan burger ever. Everyone should try it. My favourite. 4. Baked blueberry cheesecake - yummiest desert. Couldn't tell it wasn't vegan. Felt the portion was a little too small. 5. Watermelon juice - simple refreshing juice I'm a watermelon with reusable straw 6. Peach iced tea and lemonade - was just as expected. Good. The owner is a jolly person and they do compost their waste with being sustainable.” By Kirti K.

3. GoodDO - The Vegan Eatery:

Address: BIBA, G-12B, Ground Floor, Chalet Hotels Limited, The ORB Next to JW Marriott Sahar, IA Project Rd, Andheri East, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400099

Testimonials:

- “Looking for a good vegan food spot in Mumbai then good do just the right place. Located opposite to the JW Marriott hotel (airport) at the ground floor of the orb mall. Good Do serves you a wide variety of dishes in vegan. The ambience is quite spacious and the atmosphere is calm and peaceful. The lights are dimmed and beautiful. The staff is quite prompt and helpful.
Coming towards the food, I opted for the following dishes.
1 Vegicken Momos - This is a must try and gives you a feel of having a fried chicken momos.
2. Chettinad Sukka Roll with Green Mayo - It is a South Indian Paratha stuffed with Mayo and the special vegan Kheema preparation in chettinad chutney.
3. Vegicken Noodles - The noodles were perfectly cooked and the masala gave a very good taste to it.
4. Loaded Kheema Pav - Giving you a feel of the perfect roadside Kheema Pav . This dish is definitely worth a try.
5. Unmutton Briyani - The rice is a perfect blend of all the flavours added to it. The vegan chops in the dish are definitely bigger than that of others giving it the perfect briyani chicken feel.
6. Vegan Chaas - Initially i felt it was bit bitter but as we went on having it I felt it shouldn't finish.
7. Choco Chip Brownie - This place can definitely make you a brownie addict.
Overall a great place to visit to try some amazing vegan food. The cost of the food items is affordable not too high not too low. Cant wait to visit this restaurant with all my friends again.” By Preshita Parab.

- “GoodDo - The Vegan Eatery is basically a restaurant chain with a mission to serve delicious, cruelty-free food. Its best place for vegetarians as well as non-vegetarians.

I visited their outlet in The Orb the Place is serving amazing food items prepared from plant-based alternatives for meat and chicken basically healthy vegan options.

The outlet is quite bright with green and white colour altogether giving amazing vibes the staff is very polite and warming. The ambience is great to catch up with Friends and colleague for a quick chat and an healthy filling meal.

They menu consist of wide range of offering right from momos, samosas, burgers, Nuggets, Noodles, Biryani, Kheema pav and Bhurji pav, Kheema paratha, Shakes and much more.

All the recipes prepared with non-veg alternatives giving the same feel and taste while you eat.

I tried their Vegicken Nuggets which were as crispy as chicken crispy the taste was not at all a compromise.

Also, their hot selling items like Kheema pav and Bhurji pav were super-duper tempting.

The Vegicken tikka roll was delicious. Even Kheema paratha meal was extremely stomach filling.

The choco brownie shake was fantastic. Overall, the food is extremely high on protein and filled with fibres as the source is plan based.

At the End you can't miss the Brownies for sure they were pleasurable.

I loved the place and their mission to be good, eat good and Live good.” By Kinjal Jethwa.

4. Earthlings' Café:

Address: Shop No. 12 Sterlings CHS, Sundervan Complex, Mumbai, Maharashtra.

Testimonials:

- “I’m more of a vegan food hunter on my journey now to try and taste vegan food from around the world. And i must say, the vegan options at Earthlings Cafe are just amazing with tasty flavours and great portions. An amazing place to chill and have amazing food. PS: i came with non-vegan friends and they were amazed to see how vegan food could be this amazing. Would recommend to all.” by Do Good Vegan.
- “Superb place, superb food. The good here is yummy and affordable. So many things to choose from. Must check the seasonal menus. The chicken tenders and the chilly cheese toast are a must have! For meat lovers try the un chicken burger. Spaghetti bolognese is delicious too!” by Tushar Gogia.

5. Earth Cafe @ Waterfield:

Earth Cafe @ Waterfield (Guilt free, Gluten Free, Vegan, Healthy, Dairy Free)

Address: Durga Chambers, Waterfield Road, above Pernia's Pop Up - Mens, Bandra West, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400050

Testimonials:

- “When you like a place, you just want to use the best words possible ... Earth Cafe is a beautiful place with a wonderful vibe that is warm and welcoming. I would say that I felt at home immediately. It’s got a nice seating layout for the outside view. Valet parking at such a location was a definitely cool. I thoroughly enjoyed the Coffee and Pastry. Earth

Cafe made my day memorable. Keep it up guys ... you shall see me soon” by Hariharan S.

- “This place is very well maintained and service is amazing. The staff is polite and well known with food they service. Specially for vegan, lactose intolerance and gluten free food. No doubt about the food as it was very delicious. I highly recommend this place for foodies and specially vegans.” By Tejas Deshmukh.

Emerging vegan restaurants in Mumbai:

1. **Imagine by RVD**, Mulund. Imagine Cafe, Mulund West, Mumbai.
2. **Chaap Ki Chhap**, Andheri, Mumbai.
3. **Candy & Green**, Breach Candy, Mumbai.
4. **Bombay Salad Co.**, Bandra West, Mumbai.
5. **Farmer's Cafe**, Bandra, Mumbai.
6. **Sante Spa Cuisine**, Bandra East, Mumbai.
7. **Birdsong - The Organic Cafe**, Bandra West, Mumbai.
8. **Kitchen Garden By Suzette**, Bandra West, Mumbai.

Essentials to start vegan restaurants:

The Vegan trend is here to stay. According to a poll conducted in 2016 by Ipsos MORI, the number of vegans has risen in the UK by 360 per cent in only a decade. In the US, 2017 saw a rise of 600% in the number of vegans, as compared to 2014. **A similar trend has been seen in India, where the recent surge is at 360 per cent.** Consumers are becoming more aware of what they are consuming. Also, with the internet convincing people of the perks of turning into a vegan, many people are convinced to try the diet at least once in their lifetime.

The massively growing trend has had a direct impact on the restaurant industry. More and more vegan cafes are coming up and restaurateurs are incorporating more plant-based dishes in an attempt to cash in the trend. It would help if you had a clear strategy in your mind when you're about to start a vegan restaurant of your own.

Also, before you start with your plan, you must get clear about what veganism is and what it is not. A lot of people in India confuse veganism with avoiding meat from animal sources.

Veganism is not the same as being a vegetarian. It means avoiding the use of any products derived from animals. Items like dairy products, sarees, leather products, and other commodities from your daily life that contribute to the slaughter or exploitation of animals are to be excluded in veganism.

Strategies To Run A Vegan Cafe/Restaurant Successfully:

Here are a few strategies that you can consider incorporating in your plan before starting up a vegan cafe.

1. Higher Start-up Costs:

While adopting the vegan trend, you need to figure out your finances. Unlike what goes into getting raw materials for a typical restaurant, getting organic raw materials or vegan ingredients is going to cost you more. Starting up a vegan cafe would cost you up to 10 per cent more than the average cost of opening an ordinary restaurant.

2. Expect Price Fluctuations:

The organic ingredients are on the expensive side, as compared to other ingredients. With the increasing demand for vegan food, you can expect fluctuations in your raw material prices.

“The more organic the food, the more we have to raise our costs, and the more creative you have to become. It’s tough to convince people that a plate of tofu or carrot risotto should be more than steak,” says Amanda Cohen, owner and head chef of Dirt Candy, New York City’s premier chain of vegetarian restaurants.”

Along with that, you need to value supplier relationships to ensure a constant supply of your selected ingredients. The best way to thrive in an uncertain market that the organic food market is to stick with the vendors you trust the most. Especially vendors you trust, because not all the vendors would give you the same quality ingredients you wish for.

3. Update Your Menu Regularly:

Consumers are likely to get bored and try new places if they don’t get enough choices at your restaurant. As a restaurateur, you need to keep up with the upcoming trends related to consumer behaviour. Use your customer data, analyse their favourite dishes, read about the latest trends, and include newer vegan dishes in your menu. You can also try keeping a separate menu for different meals at different times.

For instance, Wabi-Sabi in Kolkata has a ‘Weekend Breakfast’ menu teamed with live music, ideal for a date. Here are some suggestions that you can include in your menu:

Protein bowl with sun-dried tomatoes, oven-baked millet, spinach and peas falafel, roasted baby carrots, and many other salads would be great to make your customer’s day.

4. Market Your Vegan Café:

Marketing your restaurant is just as crucial as opening and establishing it. You must have a separate budget to spend on your restaurant marketing. By that, we don’t mean only social media, but all sorts of techniques. Here are some ways you can make customers keep coming back to your restaurant:

1. Keep a creative menu and try changing it for different seasons.
2. Organize several events at your restaurant to attract customers
3. Run Personalized Marketing campaigns and give out loyalty points to regulars.
4. Provide a diet plan for health freaks.
5. More information, more orders! Have a full menu info-board, listing the ingredients, the calories in each dish, and the way it has been prepared. Such an intensive list attracts customers and often makes them order more. Also, market this information on multiple social media platforms.

According to NRAI Food Services Report 2019, 44% of the consumers are focused on spending a quality lifestyle by choosing healthy and nutrition-rich food. Your target audience should be way beyond 44 per cent. Thus, it would help if you convinced the non-believers with real-life stories to connect with them as well.

5. Have Tasting Vegan Food Events at Your Restaurant:

Avoiding vegan stereotypes by hosting a tasting event at your restaurant helps you gain more popularity with your customers. You can start by analysing the trends and asking your chef to come up with something new. Many restaurants have adapted the phenomenon of menu tasting to validate the chef's creations. The events would work wonders for your restaurant by getting in more and more people.

6. Get feedback from your customers:

Getting the right feedback from your customers on a real-time basis helps your restaurant grow. Feedback is more critical for a vegan restaurant since the target audience is incredibly self-aware. They know exactly what they want, and thereby might choose another restaurant over yours for just one single flaw.

All in all, keeping up with the vegan trend can be huge for your restaurant if you have a clear strategy in your head. Running a vegan cafe successfully would also require constant input from the customers, dieticians, and other people related to the healthcare industry. Consider keeping in touch with the experts to tap the massive potential of the vegan trends in the restaurant sector!

Ultimately, it's wise to talk to your doctor about veganism pros and cons. Determine whether you need daily supplements, or have any conditions which may lead to problems with a vegan diet. Then be sure to follow up with routine visits and blood tests.

Surveying the Pros and Cons of Acceptance of Veganism.

A well planned diet is one of the most important aspects for human health in modern society, Inadequately planned diets are one of the leading causes of Chronic diseases. Of the various health-related dietary models that can be adopted, such as Gluten-free, Low Calorie, etc., 'Veganism', a diet where all animal products—notably, dairy, eggs, and meats are excluded, is one of the more popular ones. Vegetarian and Vegan diets have been known and followed since antiquity, Pythagoras being one of the earliest supporters of this eating habit. These early practitioners of vegan and vegetarian diets did not have any scientific data to support the benefits received from it, only in the recent few years, due to the plethora of research and tests conducted, has veganism seen an exponential increase popularity. Looking at the interest in the term 'vegan' one can find the following trend a period of three years from 2011-2014, Veganism has seen a spike in interest by factors of 30 in China, 20 in Australia, 8-15 in most European countries, 5 in Peru, Croatia and Israel and 2 in the USA, India, Argentina, Japan and South Africa. (Sutter, 2017)

Although the popularity of a diet is not necessarily directly correlated to its positive health effects, many studies have found that a Vegan diet has more positive than negative effects on the health of an individual following such a diet. According to The Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics on Vegetarian and Vegan diets in 2016, **appropriately planned vegetarian, including vegan, diets are healthful, nutritionally adequate, and may provide health benefits for the prevention and treatment of certain diseases. These diets are appropriate for all stages of the life cycle, including pregnancy, lactation, infancy, childhood, adolescence, older adulthood, and for athletes.** That being said, some studies have found negative health effects in certain individuals following a vegan diet.

Pros of adherence to a vegan diet:

Adherence to a plant-based diet has shown that, in two groups of overweight adults put on a planned calorie deficient diet, the group consuming a higher volume of calories as vegetables lost a significantly higher amount of weight (Tapsell, *et al.*, 2014). Hence, in the short term, consuming a higher proportion of the dietary energy as vegetables as compared to animal-sourced food may support a greater weight loss and the dietary pattern appears sustainable.

Based on three prospective cohort studies, it was found that having a diet that emphasized plant foods and was low in or devoid of animal foods was associated with a reduction of about 20% in the risk of diabetes (Satija, *et al.*, 2016).

A study consisting of nearly 50,000 participants compared the BMIs and diabetes risk of those following a vegan diet, vegetarian diet, and its variations, and an omnivore diet. The results showed that the average BMI of vegans was 23.6 kg/m² and 28.8 kg/m². The authors concluded that vegan and vegetarian diets may play a beneficial role in promoting health and preventing obesity (Tonstad, *et. al.*, 2009).

Studies have shown that an increase in intake of foods that are absent in a vegan diet such as Red meat, Dairy, etc. increase the risk of cancer (Chan JM, Stampfer MJ, *et al.*, 2001) whereas an increase of foods that are abundant in a vegan diet such as Whole grains, Seeds & Nuts, Berries, etc. has been shown to be ‘cancer-fighting’. A meta-analysis of 24 cross-sectional studies and 4 prospective cohort studies found that vegan diets were associated with a 15% risk reduction in total cancer incidence, although no difference was observed for mortality. (Dinu M, Abbate R, *et al.*, 2017)

Phytoestrogens, are a naturally-occurring compound that behaves similarly to mammalian estrogens, they are present in berries, wine, grains and nuts, but are most abundant in soybeans and other legumes (Kurzer MS, Xu X., 1997) have been observed to have many positive effects such as prevention of osteoporosis, and reducing the risk of coronary heart disease, etc. (Food and Drug Administration, 1999)

Cons of adherence to a vegan diet:

An insufficient intake of protein is something expected of a vegan diet due to the lack of vegan foods that are rich in protein. Such a lack of protein will decrease the amount of essential amino acids, anorexigenic and metabolic hormones, reducing of energy, digestibility and decreasing of lean mass. (Diana-Nicoleta Raba, *et al.*, 2019)

An increase in weight loss due to higher plant-based caloric can have negative effects on some individuals due to a higher average basal metabolic rate or increased daily physical activity. Hence, they would have to greatly increase their daily caloric intake to compensate for the weight loss experienced.

Phytoestrogens have been found to be similar in function to endocrine disruptors in the brain and reproductive tract in adult humans. For example, in a 2008 clinical case report, physicians at SUNY Downstate Medical Center treated three women (aged 35–56) for a similar suite of symptoms including abnormal uterine bleeding, endometrial pathology and dysmenorrhea. In all three cases, symptoms ameliorated after soy intake was reduced or eliminated, demonstrating that consumption of particularly high isoflavone levels can compromise female reproductive health. (Chandrareddy A, Muneyyirci-Delale O, et al., 2008)

Food, when obtained only from plant-based sources will lacking in vitamin B-12(Cobalamin) as cobalamin occurs in substantial amounts only in foods derived from animals and is essential for one-carbon metabolism and cell division; some of the neurological damage caused by a lack of vitamin B-12 are irreversible. Studies found stage III of vitamin B-12 deficiency in over 60% of vegetarians (and subsequently vegans), thus underlining the importance of cobalamin monitoring in this dietary group. (Herrmann W., Geisel J. ,2003)

Vegan Alternatives:

Once upon a time, vegan alternatives to animal products were unappealing and hard to find. But today, hundreds of delicious products on the market offer outstanding alternatives to every non-vegan food imaginable. Some of the most popular all-vegan brands include Gardein, Beyond Meat, Miyoko's Creamery, and Silk.

No matter what non-vegan food you want to replace, you'll find excellent vegan counterparts. Everything from hot dogs to cream cheese to eggs. Most of these products are rich in protein and other nutrients. They can enable you to rid your diet of animal products without any feeling of sacrifice.

There has never been a better time to eat vegan. The competition among vegan foods is intense, and mediocre products can't long survive.

1. Vegan butter alternatives:

- **VEGETABLE OIL**

Vegetable oils, like canola, soybean, or corn, are all cheap and readily-available dairy substitutes but are best for one specific use.

Since oil is liquid and regular butter is solid, you can use this oil in place of softened or melted butter in your favourite baking recipes. If the butter is meant to be in a stable, room-temperature form, use the next option instead.

- **VIRGIN COCONUT OIL**

Virgin coconut oil is a vegan's saviour, but everyone should include this heart-healthy superfood as a part of their diet. It solidifies at around 75°F, so those who live in seasonal climates will have oil that is sometimes solid and sometimes liquid.

2. Vegan cheese alternatives:

- **SOY AND NUT-BASED CHEESE PRODUCTS**

Cheddar, Swiss, blue - you can find a vegan cheese substitute for just about any variety of cheese in several different formats, including shredded, sliced, and traditional cheese blocks. Vegan cheese products are typically made of soy curds or nuts; there are plenty of options available to suit any need. Some brands' meltability can leave something missing, but there are quite a few brands on the market that melt decently, so experiment and find a few favourite go-to's.

- **TOFU CHEESE**

Some soft cheese substitutes can be made at home using tofu as a base.

What is tofu? It's a block of pressed soybean curds with a high-water content, which lends well to making soft cheese, like ricotta and cottage cheese. The recipes are straightforward and delicious in vegan lasagne and plenty of other dishes that require fresh ricotta cheese.

- **NUTRITIONAL YEAST**

Parmesan can enhance any dish or take an otherwise dull dish up a few notches with its salty, cheesy flavour.

The best vegan alternative for parmesan cheese is nutritional yeast, yellow flakes that don't require refrigeration. Even better, as its name suggests, nutritional yeast is, well, nutritious. It's full of vitamins, minerals, and antioxidants - put it on everything!

- **CASHEW CHEESE**

This is hands-down one of the ultimate best vegan discoveries - cashew cream and cheese, made from blending soaked cashews with other ingredients to create a dynamite cheese sauce.

3.vegan meat alternatives:

- **SOY-BASED: TOFU, TEMPEH, & MOCK MEAT PRODUCTS**

- **TOFU**

Tofu is the ultimate vegan meat substitute in cooking - you can bake, grill, or pan-fry this handy protein, which takes on the flavour of the sauces and spices you cook with it. It's one of the highest protein vegetarian options, making it a trendy choice.

- **TEMPEH**

Tempeh and tofu are both soy protein alternatives for vegan diets, but tempeh is fermented, while tofu is not. The fermentation gives tempeh a completely different, salty flavour and firm texture, making it one of our favourite vegan bacon alternatives.

- **MEATLESS MEAT PRODUCTS**

Sometimes, you might get a craving for meat that beans or tofu won't satisfy. In those cases, there are an array of vegan alternatives to meat available at the grocery store.

You can buy vegan beef burgers and hot dogs or vegan turkey alternatives, like Tofurkey, for a plant-based holiday dinner. You can also find a vegan chicken substitute for chicken burgers or nuggets and vegan ground beef to use in homemade tomato sauce or lasagna.

We don't recommend making these the main protein in your diet, as they're more expensive and processed than other protein substitutes. They're great to enjoy in moderation, especially as you adjust to removing meat from your diet.

- **NON-SOY-BASED: MUSHROOMS AND BEANS**

- **MUSHROOMS**

Mushrooms are exceptionally high in protein for a vegetable and have a meaty texture that makes them a great meat substitute. Chop them small, use them in place of ground beef, or grill whole portobello caps and serve on a toasted bun as a vegetarian burger.

- **BEANS & LENTILS**

Beans and lentils are high-protein and high-fibre vegan protein alternatives and can be used to beef up just about any recipe. Most vegans eat a ton of beans in their diet, and luckily there are plenty of varieties to keep this protein from becoming dull.

4. Vegan milk alternatives:

- **PLANT-BASED MILK: SOY, OAT, RICE & COCONUT**

Plant-based milk makes great dairy replacements in recipes or to drink all on its own. These types of plant-based milk are nut allergy-friendly and are a bit thinner than cow's milk.

- **NUT-BASED MILK: ALMOND, CASHEW, HAZELNUT & MORE**

Nut-based milk is super popular - almond milk is the highest-selling plant-based milk on the market. They can be used in the same way to substitute for cow's milk in recipes or to drink.

5. Buttermilk substitute:

When a recipe calls for buttermilk, a simple milk substitution will not work correctly. Buttermilk is acidic, so add one teaspoon of white vinegar for every cup of non-dairy milk used in your recipe.

6. Vegan egg alternatives:

- **FLAX OR CHIA SEEDS**

Two of the best vegan alternatives for eggs are flax eggs and chia eggs. Mix one tablespoon of ground flax or chia seeds with three tablespoons of water and leave to sit for 15 minutes in the fridge, creating an egg mixture. These egg replacements will be thick and gooey like a real egg and help your recipe stick together.

- **AQUAFABA**

The cloudy liquid you drain from a can of chickpeas is great for baking - it makes an excellent replacement for eggs and allows you to use every bit of the food you purchase. Win, win!

- **BANANA**

Fibrous, mashed bananas make an excellent alternative to eggs in most baked recipes; replace each egg used with one medium-sized banana.

- **APPLESAUCE**

Add a few tablespoons of applesauce to replace each egg in baked goods, but consider cutting the sugar content back, as applesauce has a natural sweetness.

- **COMMERCIAL EGG REPLACERS**

These powdered products are available at every grocery store - mix with water according to the package directions and add to your favourite recipes. They're very effective and give you a more predictable result compared to some of the other options.

Chapter 2:

Research Design.

Research Methodology

It refers to the process by which data is identified, collected, summarized, processed and analyzed to solve the research problem.

The methodology part in the paper has been divided into two parts - Data collection and Data analysis.

Research problem

This paper aims to find the acceptance and awareness of Veganism in First year student of IHM Mumbai.

Objectives

The acceptance study was conducted on the first year students of IHM Mumbai and shall consist of the following objectives:

- To critically review the popularity of vegan restaurants in the first years of IHM Mumbai.
- To analyses what and how different attributes are involved in acceptance of veganism.
- To survey pros and cons of acceptance of veganism.
- To study the level of awareness about veganism in first years of IHM Mumbai.

Research Variables

Our research aims to measure acceptability and awareness of VEGANISM based on the location and spending capacity and the diet choice of first year students and measure their satisfaction.

Research Design

Research is exploratory in nature, about acceptance of Veganism among first years students of IHM Mumbai. The data collection is done by survey through google form.

Sample

The sample selected for this research comprises the simple random First-Year Students at IHM Mumbai. In this research we will be using a probability sampling technique where we will be circulating a google form among random individuals, selected merely by chance, for our research based on certain criteria like their location so that we can gain an in-depth understanding about the acceptance of Vegan Restaurants in Mumbai. Furthermore, we intend to use non-probability sampling technique which is convenience sampling techniques where we will be choosing individuals based on their experience on vegan food for collecting the data for the research.

We believe that this is the most appropriate technique for going ahead with our research.

Data Collection Method

For this study the data will be collected from Primary source.

Primary data will be collected through survey in one phase.

For first phase a google form will be circulated at IHM Mumbai for random students in the beginning of the study. Survey will be conducted to study their awareness and experience of vegan food. The survey will be online and conducted through self-administered standard questionnaires.

Data Analysis Method

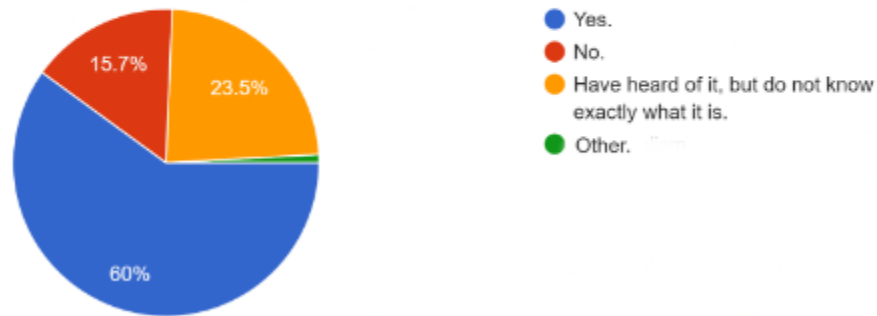
Descriptive Statistical data analysis was done in the proposed study. Word cloud and Frequency tables were used in the process.

Chapter 3:

Analysis and Interpretation of Data:

(Chart 1.1)

Do you know about the concept of Veganism.
115 responses

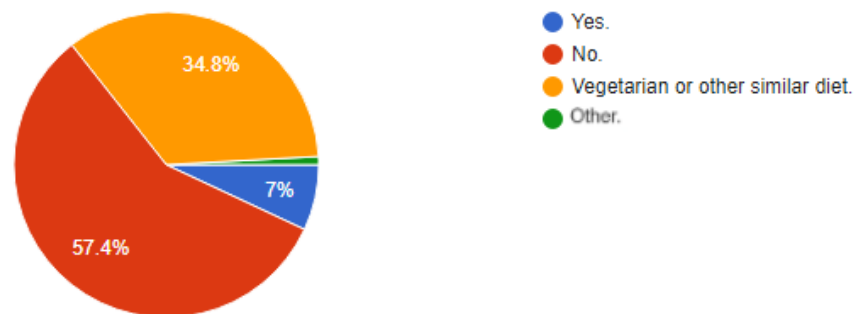


According to the survey, it was found that a sizeable percentage of First Year IHM students have not heard of veganism. Specifically, (15.7%) of respondents had not heard of this dietary choice. On the other hand, a majority of students (60%) have heard of veganism and understood it fully. However, a sizeable proportion of respondents (23.5%) have heard of veganism but were not clear about the details. It is worth noting that a very small percentage of students (0.8%) did not express any opinion on this topic. These findings suggest that while veganism is becoming increasingly popular, there is still a need for more education and awareness around this dietary choice.

(Chart 1.2)

Do you follow Veganism?

115 responses

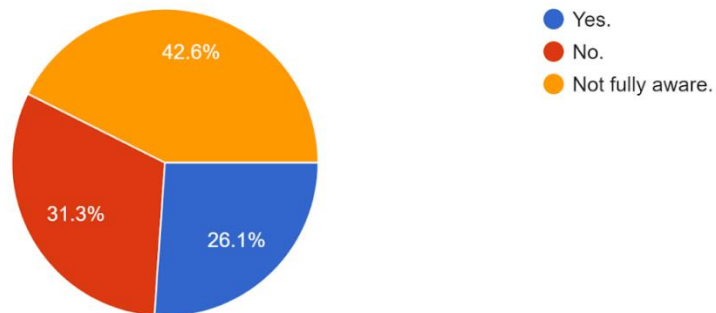


Among a group of first-year IHM students, it was found that a significant number of respondents followed specific dietary lifestyles. While a majority of students (57.4%) were neither vegetarian nor vegan, a sizable proportion of respondents identified as vegetarian (34.8%) or vegan (7%). Interestingly, a small percentage of respondents (0.8%) chose not to disclose their dietary lifestyle. These findings suggest that a significant number of first-year IHM students have adopted alternative dietary lifestyles, and the need to accommodate them may arise in the future.

(Chart 1.3)

Are you aware of the health benefits offered by a vegan diet?

115 responses

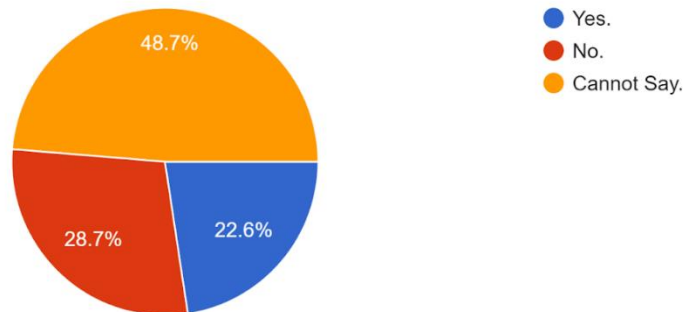


The data reveals that among the first year students of an IHM, 26.1% are aware of the health benefits associated with a vegan diet. Meanwhile, 31.3% of respondents are not aware of these benefits. It is concerning that 42.6% of the respondents are not fully aware of all the benefits of a vegan diet, indicating a lack of knowledge and education on this topic. Further efforts are needed to inform and educate the respondents on the potential health benefits of a vegan diet to promote healthier lifestyle choices.

(Chart 1.4)

In your opinion, is veganism a healthier lifestyle choice?(As compared to other diets.)

115 responses



The survey shows that there are differing opinions on the perceived health benefits of a vegan diet. Specifically, 22.6% of respondents believe that veganism is a comparatively healthier diet choice, while 28.7% of respondents do not share this view and do not believe that a vegan diet is healthier compared to other diets. Interestingly, a significant proportion of respondents (48.7%) are uncertain or have insufficient information to make a conclusive judgment on this matter. This highlights the need for more education and awareness around the health benefits associated with veganism and other dietary choices. Overall, the findings suggest that there is a need to increase access to accurate and reliable information to help inform dietary choices and support healthy lifestyles.

(Chart 1.5)

Will you switch to vegan diet because of its health benefits?

114 responses

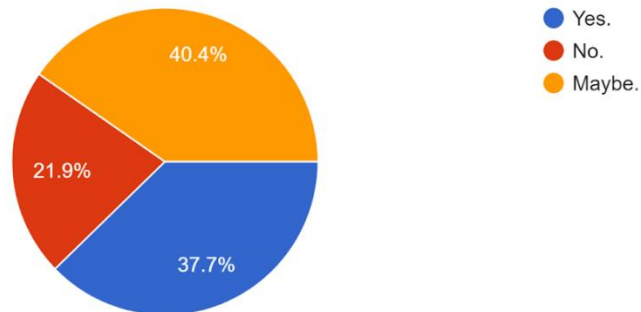


A significant proportion of respondents are open to the idea of switching to a vegan diet. Specifically, 19.3% of respondents report that they will switch to a vegan diet because of the health benefits associated. On the other hand, 26.3% of respondents report that they will not switch their diet, while 21.9% are uncertain and might change their diet. Interestingly, 22.8% of respondents report that they will not switch to a vegan diet because they have insufficient information regarding the benefits associated, indicating a potential need for more education and awareness on this topic. Finally, 9.6% of respondents report that they are unable to switch to a vegan diet due to other factors. These findings suggest that while some students are receptive to the idea of a vegan diet, there are various factors that may influence their decision-making, and more information and support may be needed to encourage a shift towards plant-based diets.

(Chart 1.6)

Will opting to follow a Vegan diet lead to too many restrictions in your lifestyle.

114 responses

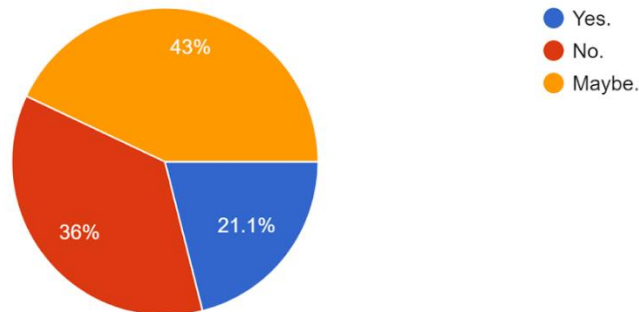


The data shows that among the first year students of an IHM, 37.7% believe that following a vegan diet will lead to too many restrictions in their lifestyle. On the other hand, 21.9% of the respondents do not think that a vegan diet would lead to many restrictions. Meanwhile, 40.4% of the respondents were unsure or undecided, indicating a lack of knowledge or experience in this area. These results suggest that some first year students may have misconceptions or concerns about the practicality of a vegan diet, which could influence their dietary choices.

(Chart 1.7)

Do you feel there is enough information or help for people to follow veganism in India?

114 responses



The study reveals varying opinions on the availability of information regarding veganism. Specifically, 21.1% of respondents believe that there is a sufficient amount of information available to make an informed dietary choice, while 36% of respondents believe that there is an insufficient amount of information available on this topic. Interestingly, a significant proportion of respondents (43%) do not have a firm opinion on the sufficiency of information regarding veganism, which may be due to various factors such as limited access to information channels or the prevalence of false information. These findings suggest that there may be a need for more accessible and reliable sources of information on veganism, which can help individuals make informed dietary choices. Overall, the results emphasize the importance of providing accurate and comprehensive information to support healthy dietary choices among the student population.

(Chart 1.8)

Can you differentiate between Non-vegan food products and their Vegan counterparts?

115 responses

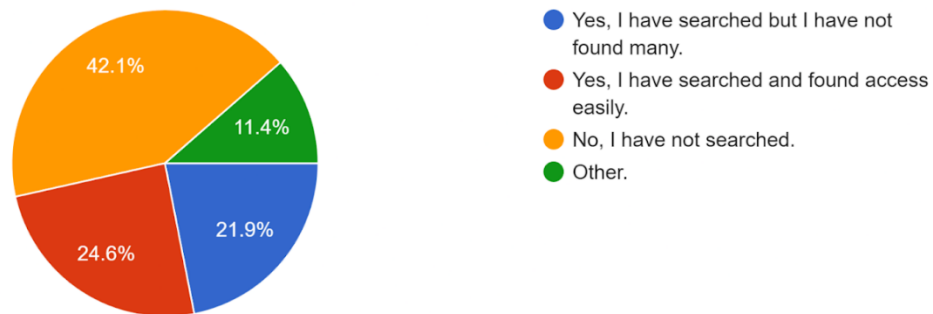


The data shows that among the first year students of an IHM, 21.7% of respondents claim that they can differentiate between non-vegan food products and their vegan counterparts. However, 26.1% of respondents say they are unable to distinguish between the two types of food products. Interestingly, 38.5% of respondents have never consumed vegan food products, which may contribute to their inability to differentiate between the two types of food. Additionally, 15.7% of respondents are unsure, suggesting a lack of knowledge or experience in this area. These results highlight the need for further education and awareness campaigns to promote the benefits and differences between vegan and non-vegan food products, especially among those who have never consumed vegan food products.

(Chart 1.9)

Have you searched for Vegan Products? If so, are vegan products easily available to you?(Commercially)

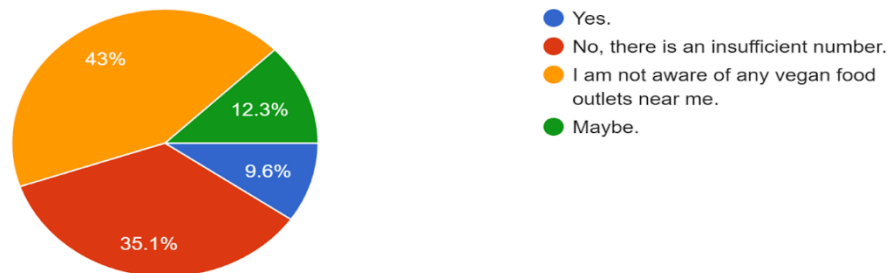
114 responses



The results show that 21.9% of respondents have searched for vegan substitutes but have not found a sufficient amount of options. In contrast, 24.6% of respondents have searched for vegan substitutes and have found a sufficient amount of options. Interestingly, a significant proportion of respondents (42.1%) have not searched for vegan products, which may be attributed to a lack of interest or knowledge about vegan products. It is worth noting that 11.4% of respondents did not disclose their opinion on the matter. These findings highlight the importance of promoting awareness and availability of vegan substitute products to support individuals who choose to follow a vegan diet or lifestyle. Overall, the results of the study highlight the need to continue efforts to improve access to diverse and nutritious food options for all individuals.

(Chart 1.10)

Do you think that there is a sufficient number of vegan food outlets near your place of residence?
114 responses

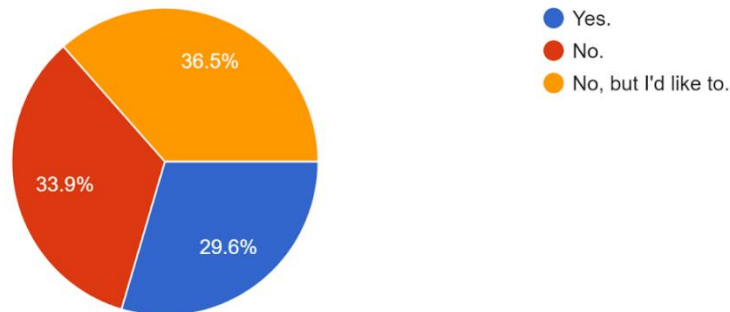


One of the main aims of the study is to understand their perceptions of the availability of vegan restaurants near their place of residence. The results indicate that only 9.6% of respondents think that there are a sufficient number of vegan restaurants in their area. On the other hand, a significant proportion of respondents (43%) are not aware of any vegan restaurants near their place of residence, which could be attributed to a lack of visibility or information about such establishments. Furthermore, 35.1% of respondents feel that there are an insufficient number of vegan restaurants, indicating a potential gap in the market. Interestingly, 12.3% of respondents are unsure about the sufficiency of the number of restaurants. These findings highlight the need to promote awareness and visibility of vegan restaurants and other plant-based food options, especially in areas where there is a perceived lack of availability.

(Chart 1.11)

Have you ever consumed any of the Vegan alternatives to Non-vegan food?

115 responses



One of the many aims of the study was to understand the students' attitudes towards vegan alternatives to non-vegan food products. The results indicate that 33.9% of respondents have not consumed and are not interested in consuming vegan alternatives to non-vegan food. On the other hand, a significant proportion of respondents (36.5%) have not yet consumed vegan alternatives but are interested in doing so, indicating a potential market for vegan products. Additionally, 29.6% of respondents have already tried vegan alternatives to non-vegan food, indicating a growing interest in plant-based options. These findings suggest that there is an opportunity for manufacturers and retailers and restaurants to cater to the growing demand for vegan products among students, especially those who are interested in trying vegan alternatives. As such, it is essential to promote awareness and educate consumers about the benefits of plant-based diets and the range of vegan products available in the market. This could help to not only increase demand for vegan products but also promote healthier and more sustainable eating habits among students.

(Chart 1.12)

Are you aware of the various Vegan bakery products available in the market? If so, have you searched for them?

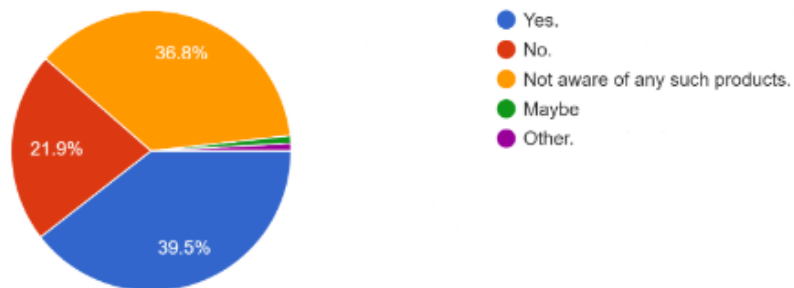
115 responses



The results of the survey show that the majority of first-year students at IHM are not fully aware of vegan bakery substitutes. Specifically, 37.4% of respondents reported having no knowledge of these alternatives. However, 33.9% of participants claimed to be aware of vegan bakery substitutes, but have not searched for them commercially or used them. On the other hand, 12.2% of the respondents reported that they are aware of vegan products and have had no barriers in obtaining the products they were seeking. Surprisingly, 16.5% of respondents did not find any of the options to be representative of their opinion. This shows that a significant portion of students are disinterested in, or unable to, use vegan substitutes when baking despite the growing demand of such products commercially showcasing potential gap in the market.

(Chart 1.13)

Do you think that adoption of veganism is easier due to the widespread availability of Mock Meats and Dairy Alternatives?
114 responses



The study revealed that a considerable portion of respondents believe that the widespread availability of mock meats and vegan dairy substitutes makes it easier to adopt veganism. Specifically, 39.5% of participants reported that they think access to these alternatives makes veganism easier to adopt. In contrast, 21.9% of respondents did not share this viewpoint, with reasons ranging from limited access to undesirable taste and texture of substitutes. Meanwhile, 36.8% of respondents reported that they are not aware of any mock meats or vegan dairy substitutes, while 0.9% were unsure, and the same percentage chose not to disclose their opinion. These results suggest that while many believe that vegan substitutes make it easier to adopt a vegan lifestyle, there is still a need for more information and education to increase awareness of the various alternatives available to them.

(Chart 1.14)

Do you think that baking and cooking with Vegan substitutes can get expensive?

115 responses

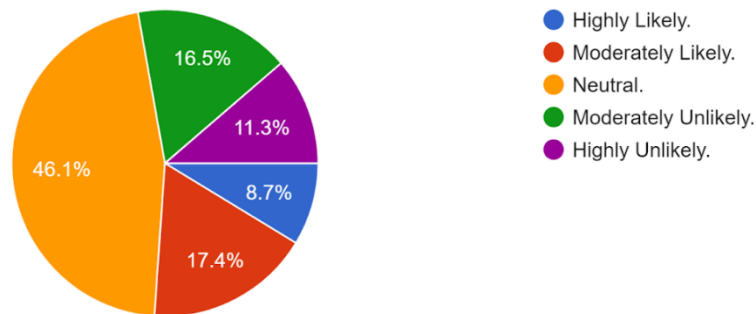


The survey revealed that many respondents believe that vegan substitutes may be more expensive than their non-vegan counterparts. Specifically, 21.7% of participants believe that vegan substitutes are more expensive, but they find the additional expense to be marginal. In contrast, 27.8% of respondents believe that vegan substitutes are more expensive and that this deters them from using them. On the other hand, 15.7% of respondents reported that they do not believe that vegan substitutes are more expensive. Meanwhile, 33.9% of participants reported that they do not know about the pricing of vegan substitutes as they have never purchased or consumed them. Lastly, 0.9% chose not to disclose their opinion. These results suggest that while some students find the additional cost of vegan substitutes to be negligible, others may find it prohibitive. Moreover, there is a need for more information and education on the availability and pricing of vegan alternatives to help students make informed choices based on their personal preferences and values.

(Chart 1.15)

Based on any personal experiences, how likely are you to recommend veganism to your family, friends, colleagues ?

115 responses

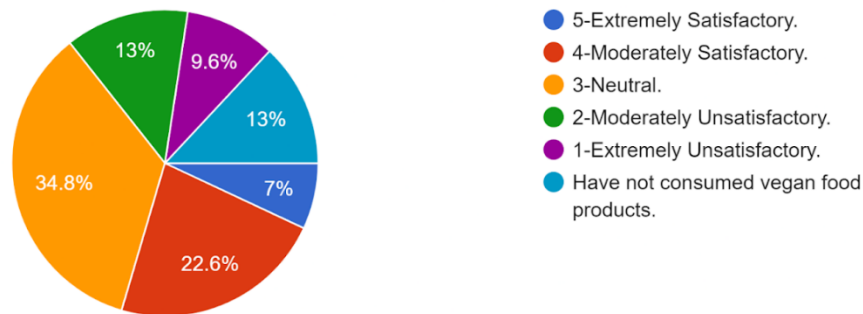


When asked about their likelihood of recommending veganism to their family, friends, and colleagues based on their personal experiences, the study revealed a diverse range of opinions. 46.1% of respondents reported a neutral stance, indicating that they neither strongly recommend nor discourage veganism. Meanwhile, 17.4% of respondents reported being moderately likely to recommend veganism, while 16.5% reported being moderately unlikely to do so. In addition, 8.7% of respondents reported being highly likely to recommend veganism based on their personal experiences, while 11.3% reported being highly unlikely to recommend it. These results suggest that while some students may have positive experiences with veganism, their likelihood of recommending it may be tempered by other factors such as personal preferences or social norms. On the other hand, some students may have had negative experiences that deter them from recommending veganism. Overall, the results highlight the need for further research on the factors that influence people's attitudes towards veganism and the potential role of education and awareness campaigns in promoting it.

(Chart 1.16)

On a scale of 1-5 how satisfactory was your experience of vegan food, 1 being the lowest and 5 the highest.

115 responses



When asked to rate their experience of vegan food on a scale of 1-5, with 1 being extremely unsatisfactory and 5 being extremely satisfactory, the results reveal a mixed picture. 34.8% of respondents reported a neutral experience, indicating that they neither found vegan food particularly satisfying nor dissatisfying. Meanwhile, 22.6% of respondents reported a moderately satisfactory experience, and 13% of respondents found their experience to be moderately unsatisfactory. In addition, 9.6% of respondents reported an extremely unsatisfactory experience, while only 7% reported an extremely satisfactory experience. Surprisingly, 13% of respondents have not consumed vegan food products, indicating a lack of exposure to this type of food. These results suggest that while vegan food may not be everyone's cup of tea, there is certainly scope for further education and awareness campaigns to promote veganism and increase the availability and diversity of vegan food options.

Chapter 4:

Summary and Conclusion

Summary of Literature Review: -

The number of vegans is on the rise globally, with a significant increase in the UK, the US, and India. This trend has impacted the restaurant industry, with more vegan cafes and restaurants opening up and traditional restaurants incorporating more plant-based dishes. Starting a vegan cafe/restaurant requires a clear strategy, and it is crucial to understand the difference between veganism and vegetarianism. Veganism means avoiding any products derived from animals, including dairy, leather, and other commodities that contribute to the exploitation of animals.

Adherence to a plant-based diet has shown that, in two groups of overweight adults put on a planned calorie deficient diet, the group consuming a higher volume of calories as vegetables lost a significantly higher amount of weight (Tapsell, et al., 2014). Hence, in the short term, consuming a higher proportion of the dietary energy as vegetables as compared to animal-sourced food may support a greater weight loss and the dietary pattern appears sustainable.

Studies have suggested that a plant-based, low-animal food diet can reduce the risk of diabetes by 20% and may prevent obesity. Furthermore, a vegan diet has been linked to a 15% reduction in cancer incidence, with phytoestrogens found in plant-based foods such as soybeans and legumes providing benefits such as preventing osteoporosis and reducing the risk of coronary heart disease. However, there are also potential drawbacks to a vegan diet. Insufficient protein intake can lead to a reduction in essential amino acids, anorexigenic and metabolic hormones, decreasing energy and lean mass. Increased weight loss may also have negative effects on some individuals, who may need to increase their daily caloric intake to compensate. Phytoestrogens, while beneficial in moderation, can also disrupt endocrine function and cause reproductive health problems in some individuals. Additionally, a plant-based diet may lack vitamin B-12, which is essential for one-carbon metabolism and cell division and can cause irreversible neurological damage when deficient. Monitoring cobalamin levels is thus crucial for those on a vegan diet.

In conclusion, starting a vegan restaurant requires a clear strategy, including understanding the difference between veganism and vegetarianism, higher start-up costs, preparing for price fluctuations, updating the menu regularly, marketing the restaurant, hosting tasting events, and getting feedback from customers. If these strategies are followed, vegan restaurants can thrive in the restaurant industry.

Summary from primary data source: -

We have found out that dairy products are difficult to replace as the intrinsic attributes of dairy foods i.e. proteins and fats that are difficult to mimic in a non-dairy substitute. More so happens because people start consuming these foods in infancy the taste preference is deeply ingrained. Respondents do feel the difference between milk based and soy based products. Once their first reference is milk based products they tend to reject plant based products made with oats and soy or other vegetable based foods. Vegan ingredients and cooking techniques can be overwhelming for beginners even if the changes are relatively small. Methods for making vegan foods creamy or cheesy involves soaking and blending cashews. Our first year students in Mumbai are still not understanding and accepting the vegan lifestyle though we

practice Ayurveda since ancient times in our nation. According to our research in acceptability on vegan restaurant we had asked our institute students i.e. first years to tell their experience about tasting the vegan food and getting their knowledge about vegan food and how much they know about vegan food so according to them from chart 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 1.4, 1.5 and chart 1.6. In chart 1.1 We get to know that veganism is becoming more popular nowadays, but there is still a need for more education and awareness about veganism. Chart 1.2 Most of the students have adopted alternative dietary lifestyles but only 7% of them have is following vegan dietary lifestyles. Chart 1.3 Benefits of vegan diet in this chart only 26.1% students are fully aware about the health benefits associated with a vegan diet we need to take more efforts to inform and educate the first year students about the health benefits of a vegan diet to promote healthier lifestyle choices. In chart 1.4 only 22.6% of students believe that veganism is comparatively healthier diet choice, while 28.7% students doesn't believe veganism a healthier diet choice and 48.7% students can't say that what is better option either a vegan diet or some other diet is a healthier option.

Overall the findings in chart 1.1 to chart 1.4 suggests that there is a need to increase access to accurate and reliable information to help inform dietary choices and support a healthy lifestyle. In chart 1.5 These findings suggest that while some students are receptive to the idea of a vegan diet, there are various factors that may influence their decision making and more information and support may be needed to encourage a shift towards plant based diets. In chart 1.6 These results suggest that some first year students may have misconceptions or concerns about the practicality of a vegan diet, which could influence their dietary choices.

From chart 1.7 to chart 1.11 These findings suggest that there may be a need for more accessible and reliable sources of information on veganism which can help individuals make informed dietary choices. In chart 1.8 These results highlight the need for further education and awareness campaigns to promote the benefits and differences between vegan and non-vegan food products especially among those 38.5% students who have never consumed vegan food products. In chart 1.9 Most of them have not searched for any vegan substitutes so the results of the study highlight the need to continue efforts to improve access to diverse and nutritious food options for all individuals. In chart 1.10 43% of students are not aware of any vegan food outlets near them. Only 9.6% think that there is a sufficient no of vegan restaurants in their area. So the need is to promote awareness and visibility of vegan restaurant and other plant based food options especially in areas where there is perceived lack of availability. In chart 1.11 As the result shows that 36.5% of students had not tried vegan alternatives but they are interested in doing so, these findings suggest that there is an opportunity for manufacturers and retailers and restaurants to cater the growing demand for vegan products among students, especially those who are interested in trying vegan alternatives.

From chart 1.12 to chart 1.16 In chart 1.12 the result of survey shows that the majority of first year students at IHM are not fully aware of vegan bakery substitutes. This shows that a significant portion of students are disinterested in, or unable to use vegan substitutes when baking despite the growing demand of such products commercially showcasing potential gap in the market. In chart 1.13 These results suggest that while many believe that vegan substitutes make it easier to adopt a vegan lifestyle, there is still a need for more information and education to increase various alternatives available to them. In chart 1.14 The survey revealed that many students believe that vegan substitutes may be more expensive than their non-vegan counterparts. Moreover, there is a need for more information and education on the availability and pricing of vegan alternatives to help students make informed choices based on their personal preferences and values. In chart 1.15 When asked about their likelihood of recommending veganism to their family friends and colleagues 46.1% of students reported neutral stance indicating that they neither strongly recommend nor discourage veganism. In chart 1.16 When asked to rate their

experience of vegan food on a scale of 1-5 with 1 being extremely unsatisfactory and 5 being extremely satisfactory the results revealed a mixed picture 34.8% of students reported neutral experience meanwhile 22.6% of students reported moderately unsatisfactory. So the overall results suggest that while vegan food may not be everyone's cup of tea, there is certainly scope for further education and awareness campaigns to promote veganism and increase the availability and diversity of vegan food options.

Final Conclusion:

The number of vegans worldwide is increasing, and this has affected the restaurant industry. More vegan restaurants and cafes are opening up, and traditional restaurants are incorporating more plant-based dishes. A plant-based diet has been shown to reduce the risk of diabetes, prevent obesity, and reduce cancer incidence. However, a vegan diet may lack essential amino acids, metabolic hormones, and vitamin B-12, and it may lead to a reduction in energy and lean mass. Starting a vegan restaurant requires a clear strategy, including understanding the difference between veganism and vegetarianism, higher start-up costs, preparing for price fluctuations, updating the menu regularly, marketing the restaurant, hosting tasting events, and getting feedback from customers. Studies show that people find it difficult to replace dairy products, and many are not aware of the health benefits of a vegan diet. There is a need for more accessible and reliable sources of information on veganism to help individuals make informed dietary choices. While some individuals are receptive to the idea of a vegan diet, various factors may influence their decision making. More information and support are needed to encourage a shift towards plant-based diets. While accommodating the dietary choices of a growing vegan community is important, and a vegan restaurant may be well-received by many, it is clear that in Mumbai, such a business would not have significant commercial viability.

Suggestions for further research:

Based on this study, we believe that these ideas can be explored upon further:

- 1)Examine the environmental impact of a vegan lifestyle in India and explore ways to encourage more people to adopt plant-based diets to reduce the environmental footprint of food production.
- 2) Examine and employ innovative methodologies to enhance the knowledge and awareness of the Indian collegiate population regarding the advantages and benefits of adopting a plant-based diet.
- 3)Investigate the factors influencing the low adoption rate of a vegan lifestyle among Indian college students, despite the long history of Ayurveda promoting plant-based diets in India.
- 4)Explore the use of innovative food processing technologies to develop new plant-based products that mimic the texture and flavor of dairy-based foods to improve the acceptability of vegan products among consumers.

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Appendix 1:

Questionnaire for the students

"Veganism is a philosophy and way of living which seeks to exclude—as far as is possible and practicable—all forms of exploitation of, and cruelty to, animals for food, clothing or any other purpose; and by extension, promotes the development and use of animal-free alternatives for the benefit of animals, humans and the environment. In dietary terms it denotes the practice of dispensing with all products derived wholly or partly from animals."

Q) Do you know about the concept of Veganism?

- 1)Yes.
- 2)No.
- 3)Have heard of it, but do not know exactly what it is.

Q) Do you follow Veganism?

- 1)Yes.
- 2)No.
- 3)Vegetarian or other similar diet.
- 4)Other.

Q) Are you aware of the health benefits offered by a vegan diet?

- 1)Yes.
- 2)No.
- 3)Not fully aware.

Q) In your opinion, is veganism a healthier lifestyle choice? (As compared to other diets.)

1)Yes.

2)No.

3)Cannot Say.

Q) Will you switch to vegan diet because of its health benefits?

1)Yes.

2)No.

3)Not enough information about the health benefits.

4)Unable to because of other factors.

5)Maybe.

Q) Do you feel there is enough information or help for people to follow veganism in India?

1)Yes.

2)No.

3)Maybe

Q) Will opting to follow a Vegan diet lead to too many restrictions in your lifestyle?

1) Yes.

2)No.

3)Maybe

Q) Have you searched for Vegan Products? If so, are vegan products easily available to you? (Commercially)

- 1) Yes, I have searched but I have not found many.
- 2) Yes, I have searched and found access easily.
- 3) No, I have not searched.
- 4) Other

Q) Do you think that there is a sufficient number of vegan food outlets near your place of residence?

- 1) Yes.
- 2) No, there is an insufficient number.
- 3) I am not aware of any vegan food outlets near me.
- 4) Maybe.

Q) Have you ever consumed any of the Vegan alternatives to Non-vegan food?

- 1) Yes.
- 2) No.
- 3) No, but I'd like to

Q) Can you differentiate between Non-vegan food products and their Vegan counterparts?

- 1) Yes.
- 2) No.
- 3) Have never consumed Vegan products.
- 4) Maybe

Q) Are you aware of the various Vegan bakery products available in the market? If so, have you searched for them?

- 1) Yes, I'm aware, but I have not searched.
- 2) Yes I'm aware and have found the products I was looking for.
- 3) No, I do not know about vegan bakery products.
- 4) Other.

Q) Do you think that baking and cooking with Vegan substitutes can get expensive?

- 1) Yes, but the additional expense is marginal.
- 2) Yes, and the additional expense deters me from consuming vegan products.
- 3) No.
- 4) Cannot know as I have never consumed vegan products.
- 5) Other

Q) Do you think that adoption of veganism is easier due to the widespread availability of Mock Meats and Dairy Alternatives?

- 1) Yes.
- 2) No.
- 3) Not aware of any such products.
- 4) Maybe

Q) Based on any personal experiences, how likely are you to recommend veganism to your family, friends, colleagues?

- 1) Highly Likely.
- 2) Moderately Likely.
- 3) Neutral.
- 4) Moderately Unlikely.
- 5) Highly Unlikely.

Q) On a scale of 1-5 how satisfactory was your experience of vegan food, 1 being the lowest and 5 the highest.

- 1) Extremely Unsatisfactory.
- 2) Moderately Unsatisfactory
- 3) Neutral.
- 4) Moderately Satisfactory.
- 5) Extremely Satisfactory.
- 6) Have not consumed vegan food products.

CITATIONS:

The plant-based meat industry is expanding, but obstacles remain:
<https://www.cnbc.com/2020/12/25/the-plant-based-meat-industry.html>

24th of December, 2020. Gotten to June 14, 2021

Eat green and smile: There is evidence of a link between being vegan and being happy.

Ten tracking Website for happiness.

Published on May 25, 2021, at
<https://www.trackinghappiness.com/vegan-happiness-prejudices-study.html>

14 June 2021, accessed

CERTIFICATE:

Certified that this research project titled Acceptability study of Veganism among First years students of IHM Mumbai, is the bonafide record of work carried out by Nayak Aditya Srinivas, Prachi Salphale, Prashant Sharma, Sameer Tomar, Bhagyashree Chavan, Rayan Patawari, Saurabh Shukla for final year B.Sc.Hospitality and Hotel Administration.

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